



△ The Twin Towers collapse after being attacked

11 September 2001 TERRORIST ATTACKS ON THE US

Four commercial flights from US airports were hijacked by terrorists posing as normal passengers in a co-ordinated series of attacks on the US. The Al-Qaeda radical Islamist group responsible had been founded by Osama bin Laden, a Saudi-born citizen who had earlier fought with Mujahideen guerrillas against the Soviets in Afghanistan. Two planes brought down the Twin Towers of New York's World Trade Center. A third struck the Pentagon, while the fourth crashed in Pennsylvania following an onboard fight between passengers and hijackers. Together, the attacks constituted the deadliest terrorist incident to that date, causing almost 3,000 deaths.

2000

13 December 2001
A Kashmiri insurgent group launches a suicide attack on the Indian Parliament

8 February 2002 **A decade of civil war** ends in Algeria as Islamic fighters surrender to government forces



7 October 2001 **US-LED "WAR ON TERROR" BEGINS**

In response to the terrorist attacks on the United States of 11 September, the US launched its "war on terror" by bombing strongholds of the Taliban – Afghanistan's fundamentalist government. This was followed by "Operation Enduring Freedom", the invasion of Afghanistan by US and allied forces, which was to last for 20 years.

◁ US soldiers board a Chinook helicopter in Afghanistan

"The United States of America will not permit the world's most dangerous regimes to threaten us with the world's most destructive weapons."

PRESIDENT GEORGE W. BUSH, STATE OF THE NATION ADDRESS, 29 JANUARY 2002